ECON 221 Turkish Economy

Ankara Yildirim Beyazit University

Faculty of Political Sciences

Department of Political Science and Public Administration

2026-2027 Academic Year / Fall Semester

Dr. Mert Akyuz / makyuz@aybu.edu.tr

Course Schedule & Place: Monday 13.30 - 16.30 & B-374 D-4

Course Content & Objectives:

This course examines the historical development, institutional structure and principal policy challenges of the Turkish economy from the late Ottoman period to the present. It covers state-led development, economic planning, liberalization, economic crises, public finance, monetary and financial institutions, sectoral transformation, external economic relations, labor markets, income distribution and sustainable development. Particular attention is given to the relationship between economic policies, political choices and public administration. The course aims to enable students to interpret economic indicators, compare policy approaches and assess their implications for public institutions, social welfare and regional development.

Course Requirements & Readings

All students are required to read the course materials. The textbooks are indicated below:

Kepenek, Yakup. (2011). *Development & Structure of the Turkish Economy*. METU Press

Aysan, Ahmet. Faruk., Babacan, Mehmet., Gür, Nurullah., & Karahan, Hatice. (Eds.). (2018). *Turkish Economy: Between Middle Income Trap and High Income Status*. Palgrave Macmillan.

Günsoy, Güler. (Ed.). (2020). *Turkish Economy*. Anadolu University.

Meissner, Christopher. *One From the Many: The Global Economy Since 1850*, Oxford University Press, 2023

Grading

The course will have a midterm exam in the middle of the semester and a final exam at the end.

Grading will be based on the following weights: Midterm Exam (40%) and Final exam (60%).

*Note: Course attendance is mandatory.

Overview of the Course

Week 1: Introduction to the Turkish economy (Günsoy: Chapter 1&2) (Kepenek: Chapter 8) (Meissner: Chapter 1 & 2)

Week 2: Historical foundations and early Republican development (Kepenek: Chapter 1) (Meissner: Chapter 3, 4, 8)

Week 3: Post-war transformation and planned development, 1950-1980 (Kepenek: Chapter 1) (Günsoy: Chapter 1) (Meissner: Chapter 11 & 12)

Week 4: Liberalisation and restructuring, 1980-2001 (Kepenek: Chapter 2) (Günsoy: Chapter 8) (Meissner: Chapter 13)

Week 5: Post-2001 reforms and global economic shocks (Aysan: Chapter 2 & 7) (Günsoy: Chapter 8) (Meissner: Chapter 14)

Week 6: Public sector and fiscal policy (Günsoy: Chapter 3) (Kepenek: Chapter 4)

Week 7: Money, inflation, banking and financial regulation (Kepenek: Chapter 3, 8, 7)

Week 8: Midterm Exam

Week 9: Agriculture and rural development (Günsoy: Chapter 4) (Kepenek: Chapter 6)

Week 10: Industry and structural transformation (Günsoy: Chapter 5) (Aysan: Chapter 13)

Week 11: Services, Labor Markets, Public Services (Günsoy: Chapter 6) (Aysan: Chapter 14)

Week 12: Foreign Trade and Capital Flows (Kepenek: Chapter 9, 11, 16)

Week 13: Income distribution, poverty and social policy (Günsoy: Chapter 2) (Aysan: Chapter5)

Week 14: Regional development, urbanization and environmental challenges (Kepenek: Chapter 1, 3, 4, 7) (Aysan: Chapter 12)

Week 15: Review

Disability Policy: If you have a documented disability (e.g., visual, hearing, or physical impairment, etc.) that may influence your performance in this course, it is recommended to meet with the Engelsiz AYBU (https://aybu.edu.tr/engelsiz/content_list-327-yildirim-beyazit-universitesi-engelsiz-universite-birimi-yonergesi.html) to arrange for reasonable conditions (such as accommodation, etc.) to ensure an equitable opportunity to meet all the requirements of this course. You may also contact the local authority of the Faculty of Political Sciences. You should communicate your needs to the course instructor as soon as possible to ensure that any course needs concerning exams, lecture materials, etc. are met.

Artificial Intelligence (AI) Policy: The use of artificial intelligence (AI) and artificial general intelligence (AGI) tools are prohibited during classes and examinations. Students are expected to demonstrate their own understanding, reasoning, and knowledge in all classroom activities and exam answers. The use of AI and GAI tools during examinations will be treated as a violation of academic integrity and addressed in accordance with the university's policies and procedures.